

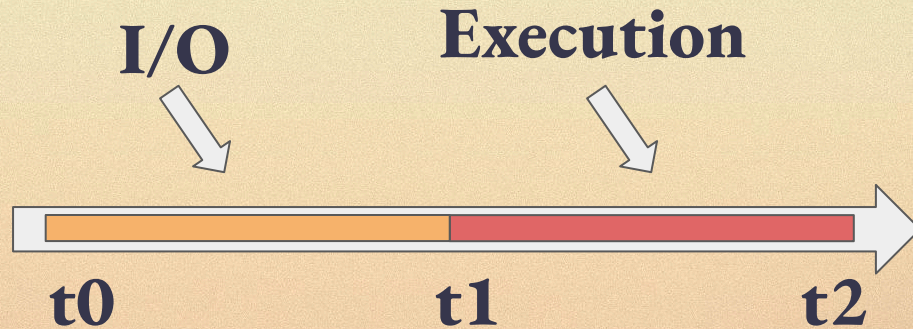
Block-level Access Lists

SIP-7928

s By Toni Wahrstätter

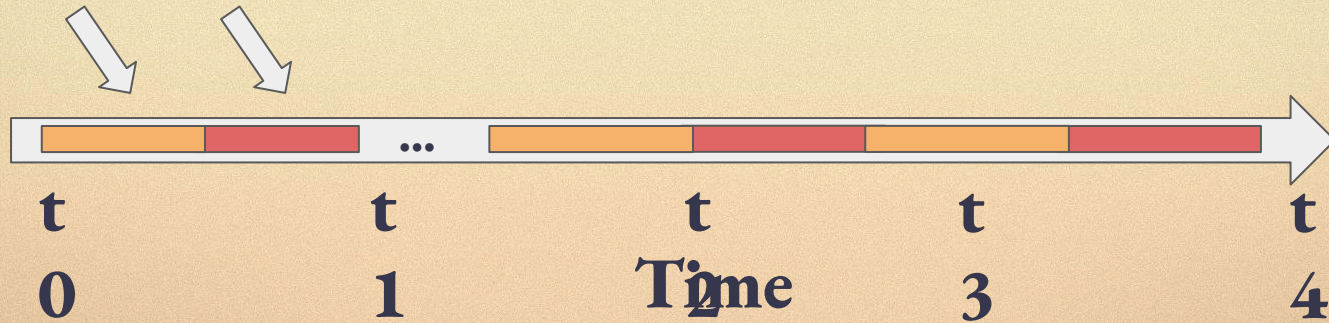
I/O and Execution: *today*

For every transaction/call/access:

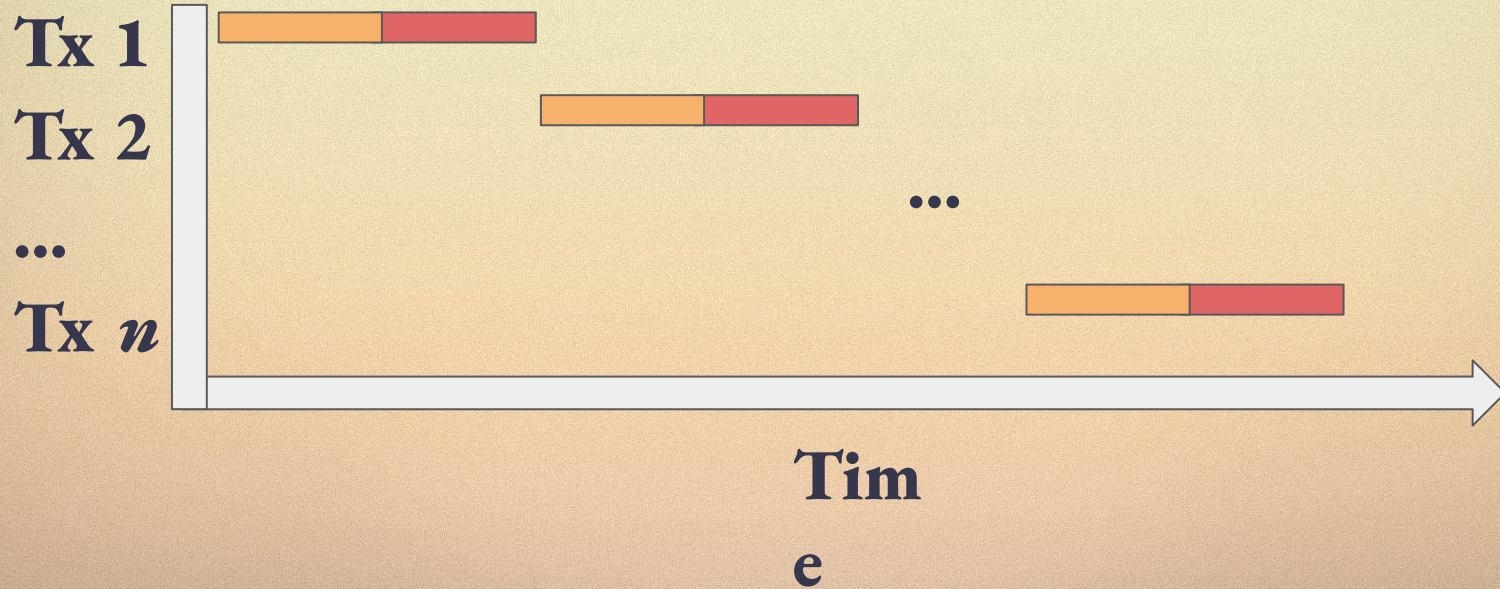


I/O and Execution: *today*

I/O Execution



I/O and Execution: *today*

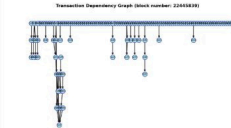


Dependency.pics

Sila Transaction Dependencies

Built with ❤️ by Toni Wahrstätter | [GitHub Repo](#) | Last Updated: 2025-05-13 15:00:04 UTC

Block 22445839

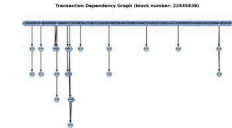


Nodes: 139
Edges: 48

Graph View

Gantt View

Block 22445838

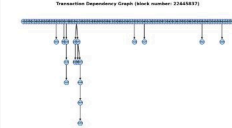


Nodes: 139
Edges: 26

Graph View

Gantt View

Block 22445837

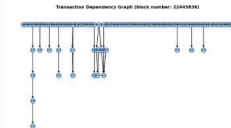


Nodes: 101
Edges: 17

Graph View

Gantt View

Block 22445836

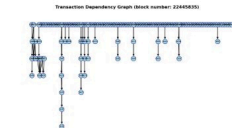


Nodes: 109
Edges: 24

Graph View

Gantt View

Block 22445835

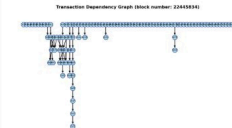


Nodes: 156
Edges: 48

Graph View

Gantt View

Block 22445834

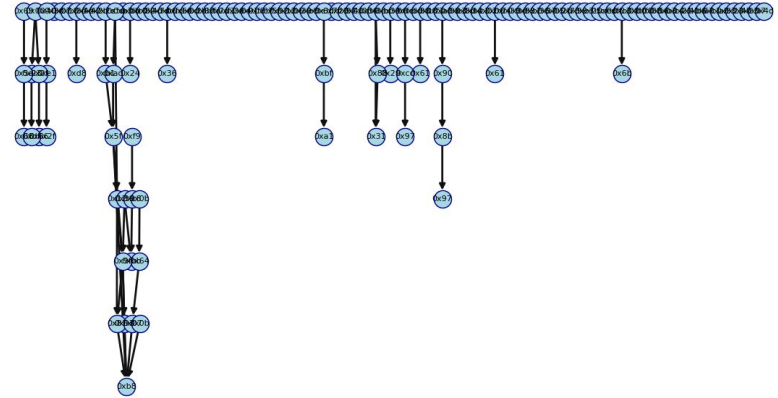


Nodes: 102
Edges: 40

Graph View

Gantt View

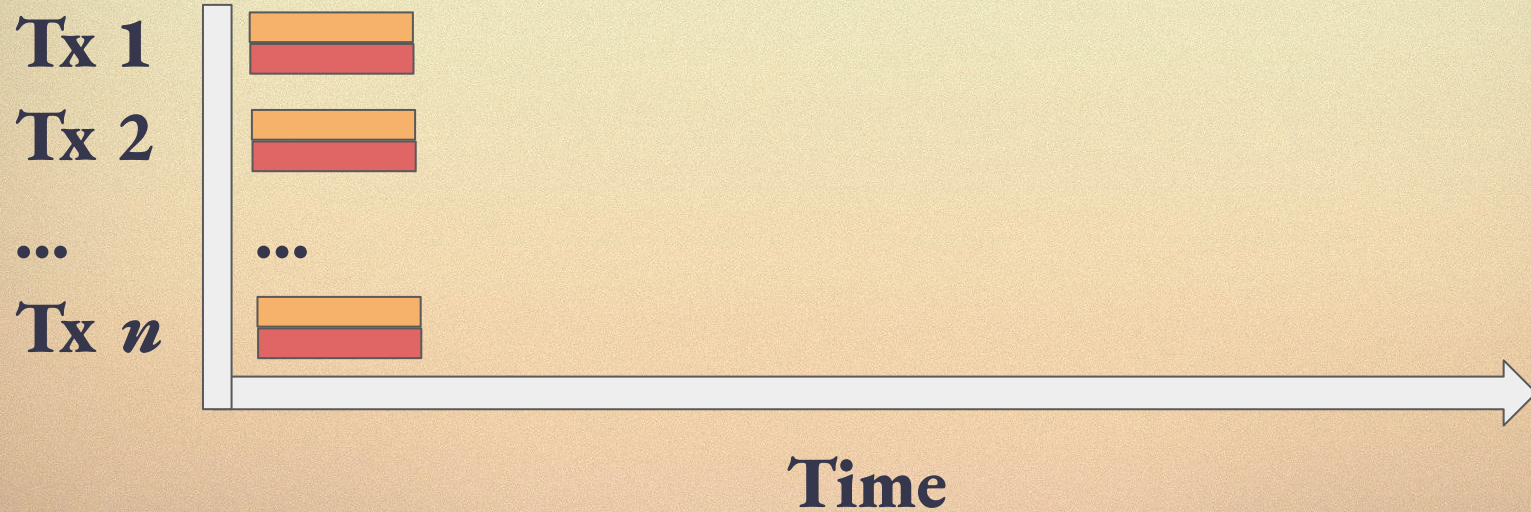
Transaction Dependency Graph (block number: 22445839)



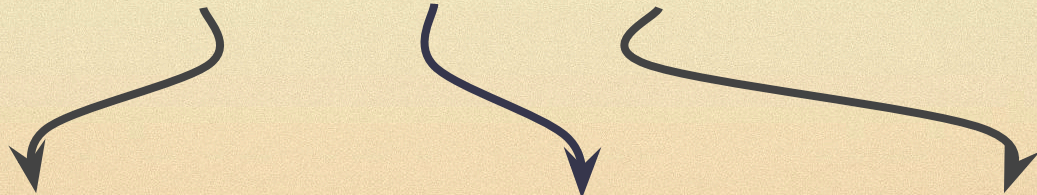
I/O and Execution: *tomorrow*



I/O and Execution: *tomorrow*



BALs



Block-level Access Lists

1

Block Structure:

today

Block				
Header	parent_hash	gas_limit	state_root ...	
Transactions	tx1	tx2	...	txn
Withdrawals	wd1	wd2	...	wdn

Block Structure:

tomorrow

Block				
Header	parent_hash	gas_limit		
	state_root		...	
Transactions	tx1	tx2	...	txn
Withdrawals	wd1	wd2	...	wdn
Block Access List	storage locations	access-state diff		

Block Structure:

tomorrow

Block			
Header	parent_hash	gas_limit	
	state_root	bal_hash	...
Transactions	tx1	tx2 ... txn	
Withdrawals	wd1	wd2 ... wdn	
Block Access List	storage locations	access-state diff	

“Builders provide mandatory access lists that let validators verify blocks faster.”

BAL Design Space

BAL Design Space

- Storage Locations
- Storage Values
- State Diffs

BAL Design Space: Storage Locations

Storage location tuples: (address, storage key)

BAL Design Space: Storage Locations

Storage location tuples: (address, storage key)

- Parallel I/O
- Parallelization for average cases
- No parallelization in the worst-cases

BAL Design Space: Storage Values

- Pre-Block
 - The value of the storage slot at the pre-state
- Pre-Tx
 - The value of the storage slot at the state before the tx
- Post-Block
 - The value of the storage slot at the post-state
- Post-Tx
 - The value of the storage slot at the state after the tx

BAL Design Space: State Diff

- Nonces
 - For CREATE and CREATE2
- Balances
 - SIL balance deltas of all accounts with changes

All other state diffs can be derived
by looking at the transactions.

Which design is best?

Some facts

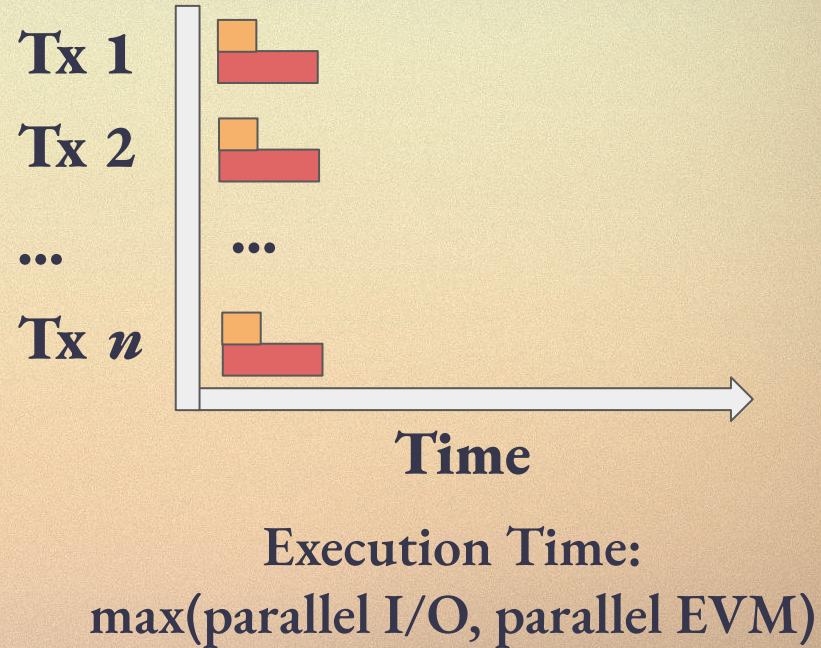
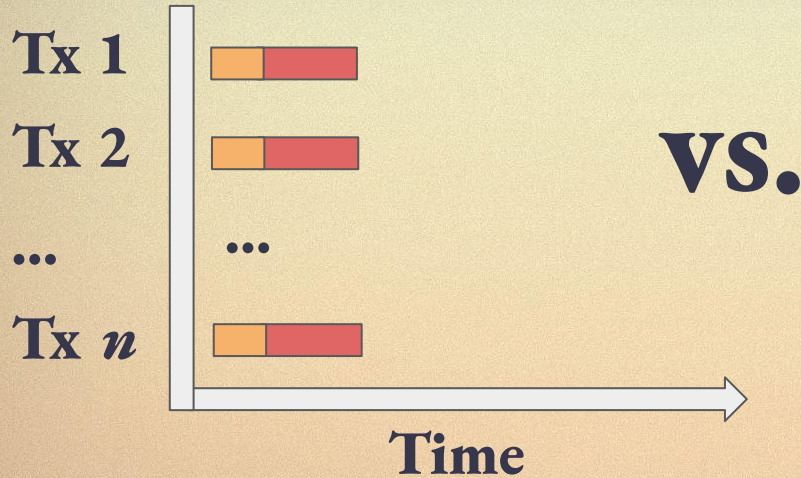
Execution is the bottleneck, not necessarily I/O

- For geth:
 - 50% EVM Execution
 - 13% I/O

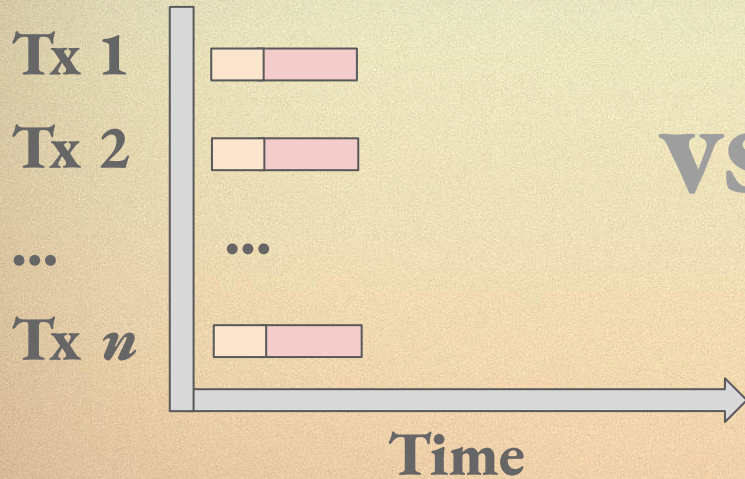
Prefetchers and similar approaches do an amazing job for avg. blocks but struggle with worst-cases

60-80% of all transaction are independent

Design Tradeoff: Post-tx vs. Pre-tx values

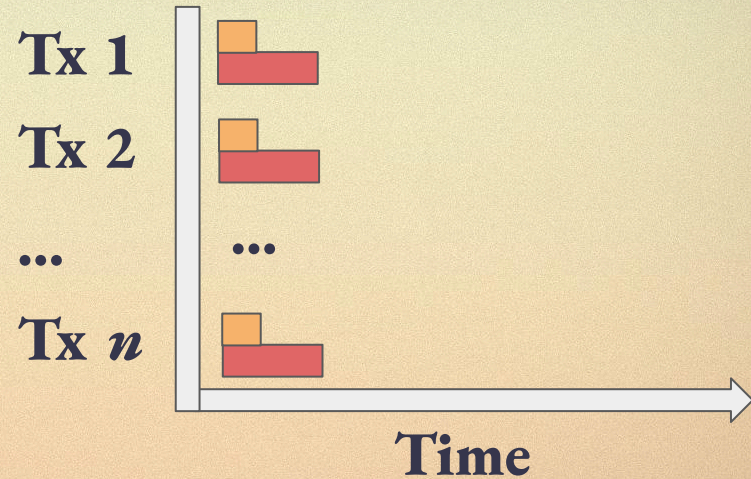


Design Tradeoff: Post-tx vs. Pre-tx values



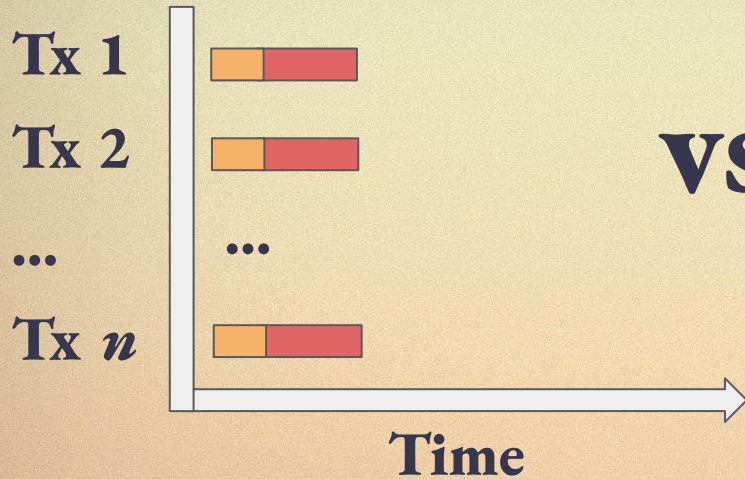
Execution Time:
parallel I/O + parallel EVM

VS.

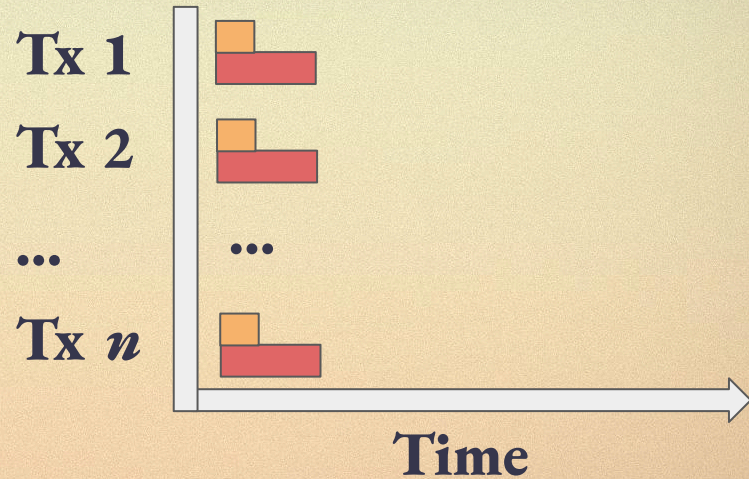


Execution Time:
 $\max(\text{parallel I/O}, \text{parallel EVM})$

Design Tradeoff: Post-tx vs. Pre-tx values



VS.



Execution Time:

parallel I/O + parallel EVM

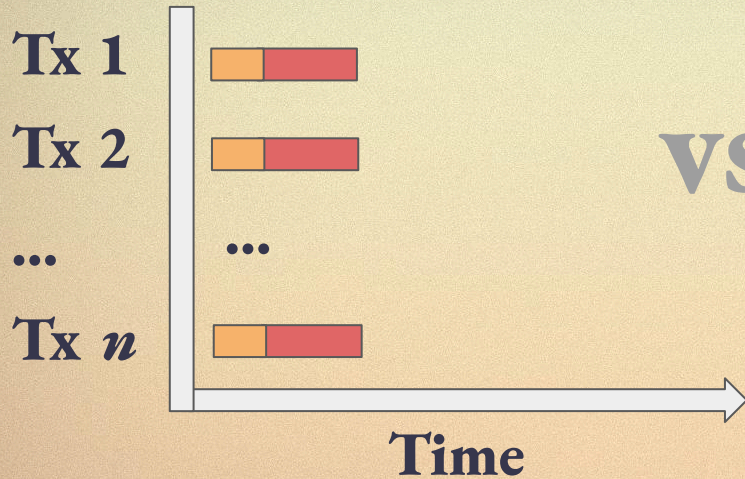
Worst-case size: 0.91 MiB

Execution Time:

$\max(\text{parallel I/O}, \text{parallel EVM})$

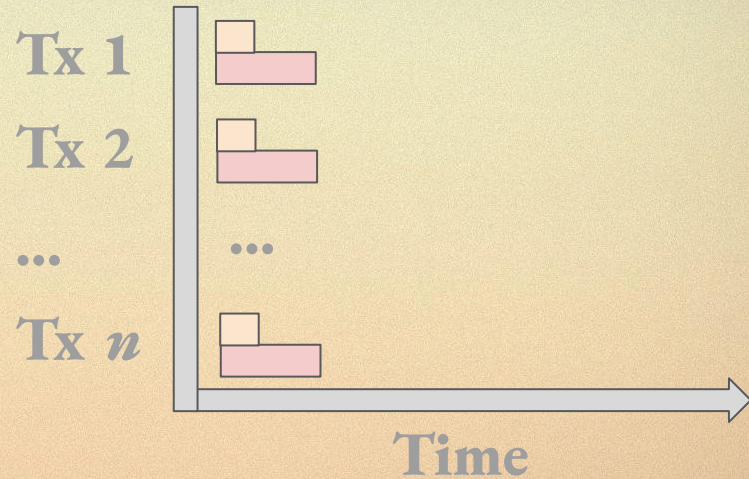
Worst-case size: 1.51 MiB

Design Tradeoff: Post-tx vs. Pre-tx values



Execution Time:
parallel I/O + parallel EVM
Worst-case size: 0.91 MiB

VS.



Execution Time:
 $\max(\text{parallel I/O}, \text{parallel EVM})$
Worst-case size: 1.51 MiB

BAL Design Space

Design	Execution Times	Max Size	State diff
Storage Locations	Parallel I/O + sequential EVM	0.93 MiB	✗
Pre-tx values ¹	max(parallel I/O, parallel EVM)	1.51 MiB	✗
Post-tx values ^{1 2}	Parallel I/O + parallel EVM	0.93 MiB	✓
Pre-block + Post-tx values ^{1 2}	max(parallel I/O, parallel EVM)	1.51 MiB	✓

¹ with storage locations

² with state diffs

Further readings

SIP-7928



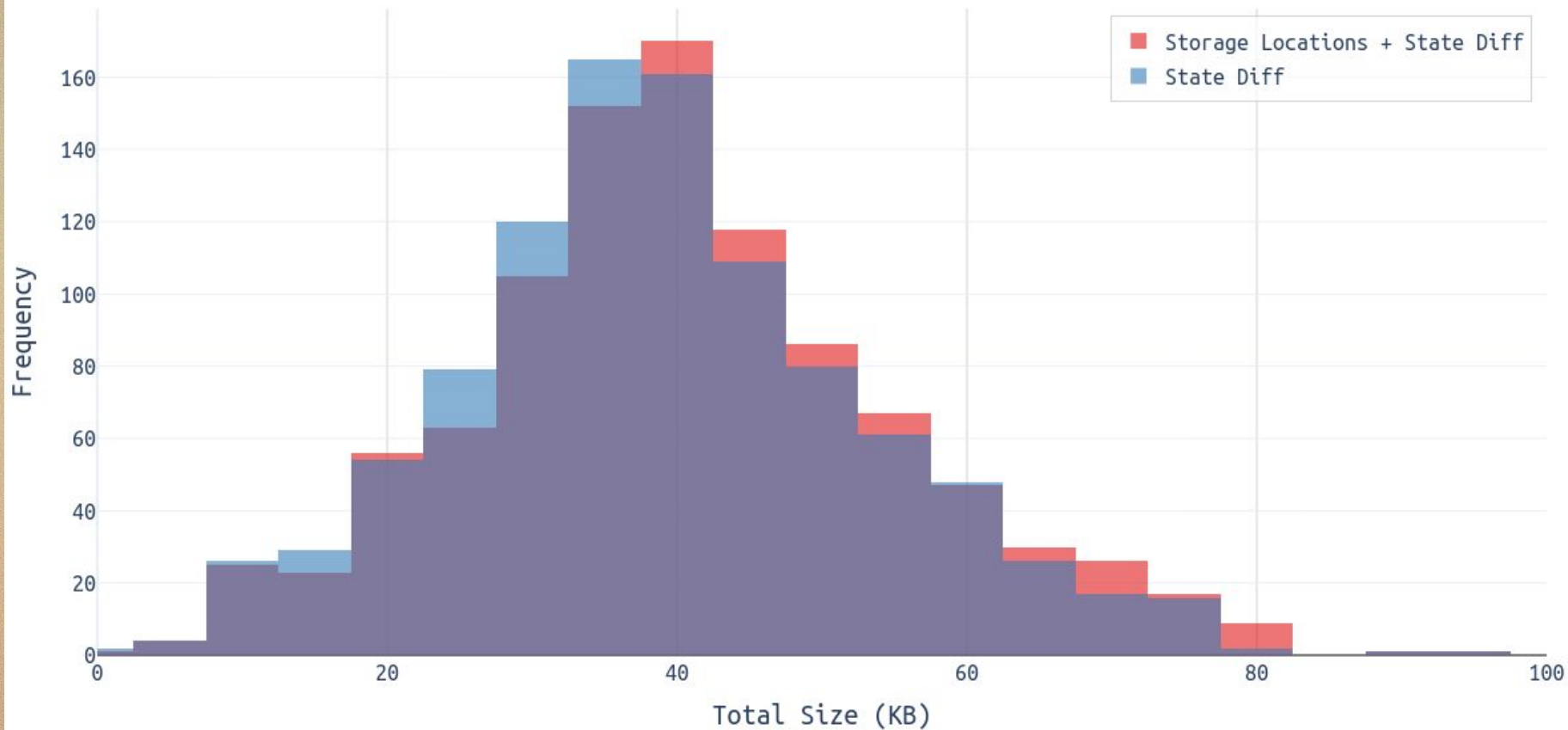
Sila Research



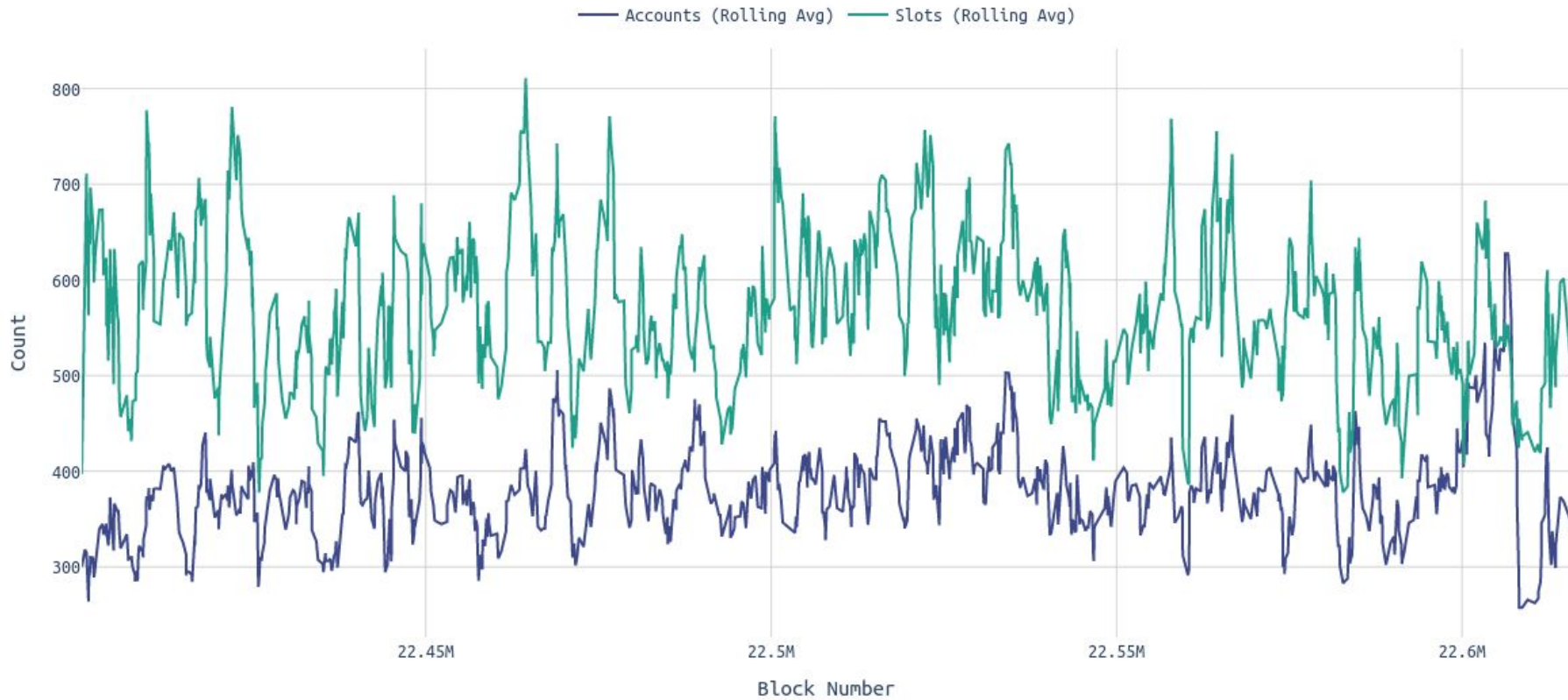
dependency.pics



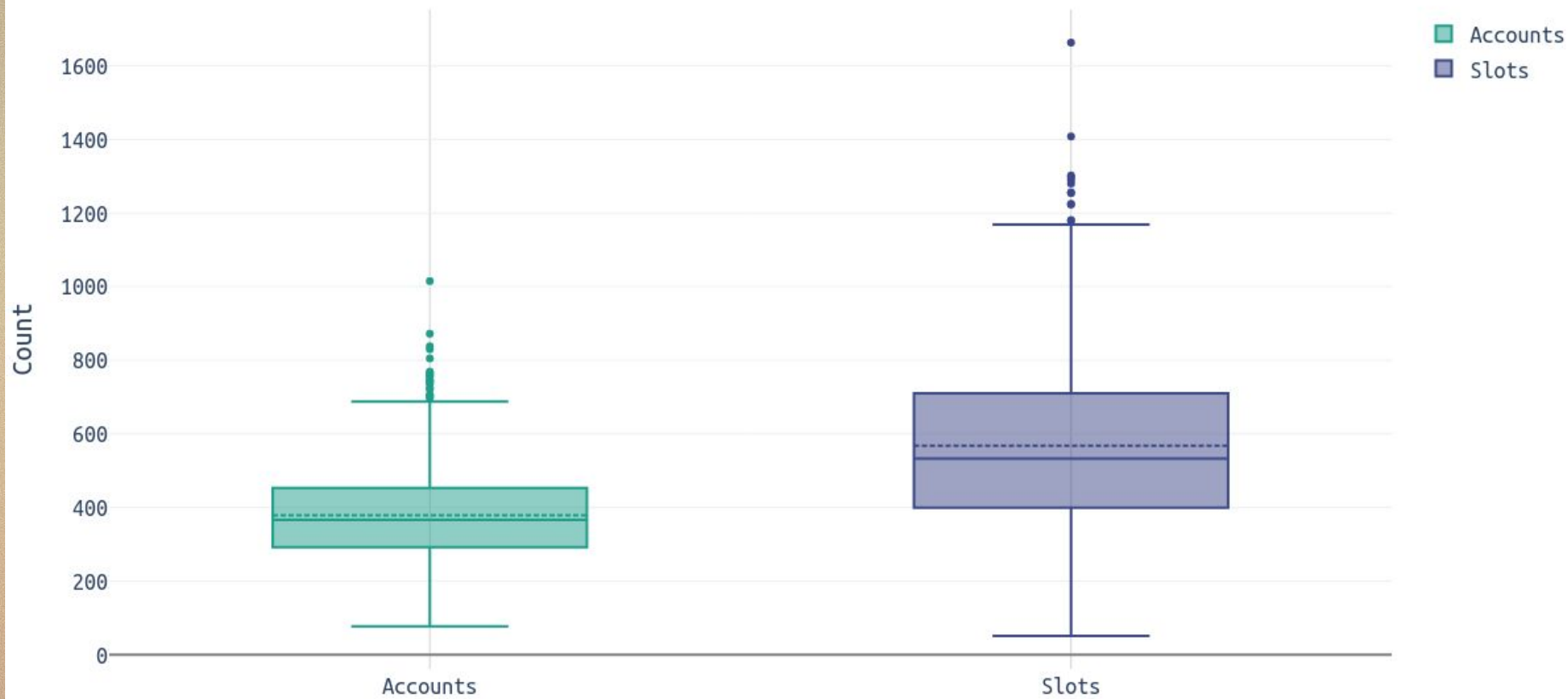
BAL Size Distribution



Acg. Account and Slot Count over Blocks



Nr. of Accounts and Slots per Block (incl. storage locations + state diffs)



BAL Size vs. Gas Used per Block

